

Mount Sinabung Errupts

A Volcano in western Indonesia erupts, sending people fleeing from their homes in panic
<http://dgit.in/Indovol>

Exploding Black Hole

The formation of a black hole on 27th April spawned the highest recorded explosion ever. Read on to know the analysis of the phenomenon <http://dgit.in/buhboom>



The oldest star system known to man, the planets around HIP 11962 were created just after the Big Bang. Just don't ask them their age in public. Sensitive topic.

haven't seen Arnold Schwarzenegger and Danny DeVito in Twins.

The Aging Hipsters: HIP 11952b and HIP 11952c

Some planets are just too old school to put up with modern science. Believed to defy "conventional thinking" (whatever that is!), these two planets are decidedly the oldest exoplanets known to mankind, with 13 billion years of history behind them. Having formed around a star called HIP 11952 these two oldies of the universe are believed to have no reason to exist by scientist, except for the fact that they do. Due to the "metal poor" status of their star - human-speak meaning that the stars don't have enough heavier elements like metals in their constitution - it couldn't have sustained the creation of these planets. But scientists are backtracking their amazement with rationalisations that the star could've been rich in the "old days" and grew "poorer" as time went on and it migrated from another galaxy to ours. Sure scientist. Sure. Blame it on emigration.

The Party Crasher: HR 8799e

Scientists had already spotted three massive sized planet in the orbit of star HR 8799 but were shocked to discover a fourth that they just can not explain. The

young star is 130 light-years away and hosts four planets that are all roughly seven times the size of our Jupiter. The orbit of HR 8799e is remarkably close to the star for a planet its size and doesn't fit into any computational model of stellar movements. Despite theories being thrown around by astronomers, such as the possibility of massive disks of dust around the star facilitating the planet formation, scientist are still left wondering about the planet's high absorption of methane as compared to its three siblings. Yes ladies and gentlemen, it farts. So as scientist prepare to run expensive computer simulations, in order to determine the principles behind their observations, we have no way of knowing if they aren't huddled up in their laboratories, just playing with the new Oculus Rift's on their Omni treadmills. We know we would.

The Baby Planet: TW Hydrae

Never let it be said that size matters. It doesn't. Just ask my girlfriend. In the case of TW Hydrae, a small planet discovered to be orbiting the star at a ladylike distance of 7.5 billion miles (twice Pluto's distance from the sun), is believed to be one of the youngest planets in existence, with only 8 million years under its belt. Not even old enough to order beer from

the restaurant at the end of the universe. Scientist's can't explain how such a young star could've raised such a young planet without the assistance of adoption services. The star being only half the size of our sun and the planet being 7.5 billion miles from the star lead scientist to calculate that it should've taken the planet 2 billion years to form instead of its precocious 8 million. And even as scientist argue whether to officially term this (6 to 28 times the size of Earth) heavenly body as a planet (common you know it is one), they nevertheless remain dumbfounded by its existence.

So Scientists Suck, Right?

No.

Even as astronomers the world over attempt to integrate the cosmic behaviours of these heavenly bodies into the knowledge they have gathered over centuries, it is enough to remind us, that humility in the face of the unknown and curiosity in the face of ignorance, still remain the defining qualities of the human spirit.

It would be easy to dismiss facts that don't conform to dogmatic knowledge or criticize scientists for being confounded. But very rarely do we experience moments of complete wonderment - moments where our knowledge and experience is overwhelmed by the sheer awesomeness of nature - and we discover a hungry emptiness in our minds that only our intelligence and imagination can fill. Its easy to be amazed and do nothing. Like magic or religion it is a superficial high. But true ascension comes when we ignite our intelligence to reach out through the veil of imagination, across the stars and touch the face of god.

"Imagination will often carry us to worlds that never were. But without it we go nowhere."

– Carl Sagan

Honorable Mentions:

- The Clingy One: Kepler-19c
- The Puppel Master: KELT 1b
- The Gentle Giant: TrES 4
- The Roadie: PSO J318.5-22
- 136108 Haumea or Haumea To All Her Friends 